

scripts/scan-no-hardcoded-hostport.sh — User Guide

Last verified: 2026-08-26 (§6.J corpus floor — "examined ZERO files" now refuses; LVA vacuous-pass sweep B2) **Inheritance:** HelixConstitution §11.4.18 (script documentation mandate)

Overview

Stub doc generated from the script's in-source header comment. See `scripts/scan-no-hardcoded-hostport.sh` for canonical behavior. This stub exists so the CM-SCRIPT-DOCS-SYNC pre-push gate (.github/hooks/pre-push Check 9) starts gating modifications to this script.

The script's own header documentation (verbatim):

```
scripts/scan-no-hardcoded-hostport.sh — standalone §6.R host:port scanner.
```

```
Purpose: enforce the §6.R No-Hardcoding Mandate clause that no
`host:port` literals in URLs appear in tracked source outside the
exemption set. §4.5.10 (CONTINUATION.md): staged enforcement —
this
is the mechanical gate that lands the rule.
```

Exit codes:

- 0 — no host:port violations
- 1 — host:port violation(s) found (paths printed to stderr)

```
Pattern: `<scheme>://<host>:<numeric-port>` where scheme is one of
http/https/ws/wss and the port is 2-5 digits. Matching only URL-
shaped
literals avoids false positives on `Map<String, Int>` declarations
or
`key:value` JSON snippets in comments.
```

Exemptions (lockstep with §6.R clause body):

```
.env.example, .lava-ci-evidence/, submodules/, tests, fixtures/,
lava-api-go/third_party/modernc-libc/, CHANGELOG.md, *.md,
*.json,
*.xml, *.yaml, *.yaml — external config and docs are legitimate
```

homes
for these literals.

Loopback hosts (localhost / 127.x.x.x / 0.0.0.0) are filtered
AFTER
the file-level exemption – those are not "hardcoded connection
addresses" in the §6.R sense.

Usage

See the script's in-source comment block (above) for canonical usage
examples.

2026-08-26 update — §6.J corpus floor: an unread corpus is no longer a clean scan

All three §6.R scanners (scan-no-hardcoded-uuid.sh, scan-no-
hardcoded-ipv4.sh, scan-no-hardcoded-hostport.sh) received the same
change, for the same measured defect. Read this section together with
the two sibling docs; the text below is deliberately identical across
them because the guard is.

The defect

These scanners are silent on success — a clean scan printed nothing at
all and exited 0. The corpus came from `git ls-files -z | grep -zv
<exemptions> | while read ...`, and the whole pipeline was
terminated with `|| true`. Nothing asserted that a single file had
actually been read, so **a broken corpus was byte-identical to a clean
scan**:

```
GIT_DIR=/nonexistent/x.git    ->  uuid exit=0    ipv4 exit=0  
hostport exit=0  
control (normal environment) ->  uuid exit=0    ipv4 exit=0  
hostport exit=0
```

The decisive control: a fixture tree containing real violations of all
three rules, in a directory that is **not** a git repository, passed all three
scanners. Running `git init` on the same tree — changing nothing
about the violating content — made all three fail. The verdict was a
function of whether `git ls-files` worked, not of whether the code was
clean.

The realistic triggers are ordinary, not exotic: `index.lock` contention from a concurrent git process, a corrupt index, a `safe.directory` dubious-ownership refusal (this checkout lives on an external mount, where that refusal is a known class), or a stray `GIT_DIR` inherited from a parent process. Each one silently converts §6.R enforcement into a no-op, and — because pre-push runs these through `scripts/check-constitution.sh` — into a green push.

What the scanner now refuses

Three refusals, all **exit 2** (distinct from exit 1, which still means real violations were found in a corpus that was genuinely read):

Condition	Message	Why it is not a pass
<code>git ls-files</code> exits non-zero	6.R SCAN FAILED: could not enumerate the tracked-file corpus. — git's own stderr is reproduced, indented	The enumeration failed; a clean exit would assert nothing. The message explicitly states this is not "no violations found"
The corpus survives the exemption filter but contains no readable regular file	6.R SCAN FAILED: the scan examined ZERO files.	A clean exit over an empty corpus asserts nothing, and this scanner prints nothing on success — so the empty case is otherwise indistinguishable from a real pass
Some tracked paths are not readable regular files, are not declared submodule gitlinks, and are not reported deleted by git	6.R SCAN INCOMPLETE: the scan examined a PARTIAL corpus. — the offending paths are named	A verdict over a subset asserts nothing about the absent files. A floor that fires only at exactly zero is a floor with one stair

Each message distinguishes its cause rather than emitting one generic failure. The zero-files refusal, for example, separates "*git ls-files succeeded but the exemption filter left nothing*" (wrong tree, or the filter

regex has drifted to exclude everything) from "*paths were listed but none is a readable regular file*" (working-tree drift, not an empty repository), because those two have different remedies and a diagnosis that misstates its cause sends the reader to the wrong one.

Why the expectation is derived, never hardcoded

The floor compares against `git ls-files` output and `.gitmodules`, not against a literal file count. A hardcoded count goes stale on the next commit that adds or removes a file, and a stale floor is the same defect wearing a different mask.

Two classes of tracked path are legitimately **not** readable regular files, and both are classified rather than dropped:

- **Declared submodule gitlinks** — read from `.gitmodules` (`path = ...`). Expected; contributes nothing to scan and triggers nothing.
- **Paths git itself reports deleted** (`git ls-files --deleted`) — a pending `git rm` or an unstaged deletion. Already visible to the operator through `git status`, and a deleted file holds no content that could carry a violation. These are **excluded from the expectation** and **named in the clean verdict**, so the scanner's claim always states the corpus it actually read.

The distinction that carries the weight: *absent and reported by git* is a deletion in progress; *absent and not reported by git* is invisible drift that no other gate would surface. Only the second is a refusal.

The clean verdict now states its corpus

Silence on success was half the defect, so success now says what it examined (written to `stderr`, so `stdout`-consuming callers are unaffected):

```
6.R host:port scan clean: <N> tracked file(s) examined.
```

When pending deletions were excluded, the count is followed by a parenthetical naming how many and why.

Exit codes (updated)

The header block quoted above lists only 0 and 1; it predates this change and is incomplete. The full set is:

Code	Meaning
0	No violations — and at least one file was actually examined
1	Violation(s) found (paths printed to stderr)
2	The scan could not be trusted: corpus enumeration failed, examined zero files, or examined a partial corpus

Callers that previously treated any non-zero exit as "violations found" now distinguish 1 (a real finding) from 2 (a scan that must not be believed either way).

§6.J falsifiability rehearsal

1. `GIT_DIR=/nonexistent/x.git bash scripts/scan-no-hardcoded-hostport.sh` → expect **exit 2** with could not enumerate the tracked-file corpus and git's own stderr reproduced. Before this change: exit 0, no output.
2. Run normally in the Lava tree → expect **exit 0** and the corpus-count line.
3. `git rm --cached <some tracked source file>` (leaving the file on disk), re-run → still exit 0; the file simply leaves the corpus, and the reported count drops.

Maintenance

When this script is modified, update this document in the same commit (CM-SCRIPT-DOCS-SYNC requires it). Per §11.4.18, the documentation **MUST** stay in sync with the codebase — no doc may be out of sync with its script.

Cross-references

- `scripts/scan-no-hardcoded-hostport.sh` — the script itself
- `docs/helix-constitution-gates.md` — gate inventory
- `HelixConstitution Constitution.md` §11.4.18 (the mandate)
- `Lava CLAUDE.md` §6.AD (HelixConstitution Inheritance)